

7 Employees' information (continued)

D Share Incentive Plan (SIP)

The Company operates a SIP for all eligible employees, who may receive up to £3,600 worth of shares (Free Shares) as part of their annual bonus. The SIP is an HMRC tax-advantaged scheme.

Any Free Shares awarded under the SIP will be held in trust on behalf of each employee for at least three years following grant, after which time they may be withdrawn, provided the individual employee has remained in employment with the Company. If the Free Shares are held in trust for a further two years, they will qualify for HMRC-approved tax advantages.

As part of the SIP arrangements, the Company also offers eligible employees the opportunity to participate in a Partnership share scheme, under which employees can invest up to £1,800 of pre-tax salary (or, if less, 10 per cent of salary) in any tax year, which will be used to purchase ordinary shares in the Company (Partnership Shares) at the end of a 12-month period. The Group will give each employee one ordinary share (a Matching Share) for every two Partnership Shares purchased by the employee. Matching Shares will be forfeited if the employee leaves the Group within three years of the date of award and will qualify for HMRC-approved tax advantages if they are held in the SIP for five years.

E Save As You Earn Scheme (SAYE)

The Group operates a SAYE under which all eligible UK employees may save up to a maximum of £500 per month for a period of three or five years and use the proceeds at the end of their saving period to purchase shares in the Company. At the start of the saving period, each SAYE participant will be granted an option to purchase such shares at a price usually determined as the average mid-market closing share price of an ordinary share in the Company over the three consecutive dealing days preceding the SAYE invitation date, discounted by up to 20 per cent. Options may normally be exercised within six months following the end of the savings period.

F Joint Share Ownership Plan (JSOP)

Eligible employees were invited to participate in the JSOP which formed part of the intu properties plc Unapproved Share Option Scheme (which was replaced by the Non-approved Executive Share Option Scheme upon its expiry in April 2018) and the PSP. Under the JSOP, shares are held jointly by the employee and the employee share ownership plan trustee with any increases in the share price and dividends paid on those shares being allocated between the joint owners in accordance with the terms of the scheme.

Conditions under which JSOP interests may be exercised (including applicable performance conditions) are the same as those for the Non-approved Executive Share Option Scheme as outlined in section A.

8 Auditor's remuneration

	2019 £000	2018 £000
Fees payable to the Company's auditor and its associates for:		
The audit of the Company's annual financial statements	559	382
The audit of the Company's subsidiaries	533	441
Fees related to the audit of the Company and its subsidiaries	1,092	823
Audit-related assurance services ¹	64	51
Total fees for audit and audit-related services	1,156	874
Other non-audit assurance services ²	534	230
Total fees	1,690	1,104

1 Relates to the interim report review of the Group, and interim reviews of certain subsidiary undertakings.

2 2019 other non-audit assurance services relate primarily to reporting accountants' work associated with the potential equity raise not completed.

The reporting accountants' work surrounding the potential equity raise not completed includes a working capital report that requires the accountant to have detailed knowledge of the Group. If a firm other than the audit firm were to undertake this work, they would require a significant amount of additional time to become familiar with the Group. Deloitte was therefore chosen to undertake this work as it was considered to be sensible and more efficient both in terms of time and costs.

2018 other non-audit assurance services included £40,000 related to reporting accountants' work associated with a year end significant change report and £190,000 related to reporting accountants' work in connection with the Group's Q3 profit estimate which was required at the time due to Takeover Code rules.

The work surrounding a significant change report and a profit estimate requires the accountant to have detailed knowledge of the Group. If a firm other than the audit firm were to undertake this work, they would require a significant amount of additional time to become familiar with the Group. PwC was therefore chosen to undertake this work as it was considered to be sensible and more efficient both in terms of time and costs.

As for all 2019 and 2018 non-audit work, consideration was given as to whether Deloitte's (2019) and PwC's (2018) independence could be affected by undertaking this work. It was concluded by the Audit Committee that this would not be the case.

Fees payable by the Group's joint ventures in respect of 2019 were £156,000 (Group's share), all of which relates to audit and audit-related services (2018: £121,000, all of which related to audit and audit-related services).